

1

00:00:00,000 --> 00:00:08,240

welcome im very excited to talk about effective speaking spontaneous situation i thank you all

2

00:00:08,240 --> 00:00:12,000

joining us even though the title of my talk is grammatically incorrect i thought that scared you

3

00:00:12,000 --> 00:00:15,179

away but i learned teaching here at the business school catching attention is hard but something

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00:00:15,179 --> 00:00:19,339

as simple as that i thought might draw you so this is going to be a highly interactive

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00:00:19,339 --> 00:00:24,019

participative workshop today if you dont feel comfortable participating thats fine but do know

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00:00:24,019 --> 00:00:27,320

im going to ask you to talk people next to you therell be opportunities to stand up practice

7

00:00:27,320 --> 00:00:29,920

something because i believe the way we become effect communicators

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00:00:30,000 --> 00:00:30,839

by actually muting.

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00:00:30,839 --> 00:00:32,320

So lets get started right away.

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00:00:32,320 --> 00:00:34,920

Id like to ask you all to read this sentence.

11

00:00:34,920 --> 00:00:36,420

And as you read this sentence,

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00:00:36,420 --> 00:00:38,140

whats most important to me is that you count

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00:00:38,140 --> 00:00:40,759

the number of Fs that you find in this sentence.

14

00:00:40,759 --> 00:00:41,840

Count the number of Fs.

15

00:00:41,840 --> 00:00:42,679

Quiet yourself.

16

00:00:42,679 --> 00:00:44,100

Just another couple seconds here.

17

00:00:44,100 --> 00:00:45,700

Three, two, raise your hand please

18

00:00:45,700 --> 00:00:47,640

if you found three and only three Fs.

19

00:00:47,640 --> 00:00:48,480

Excellent, great.

20

00:00:48,480 --> 00:00:49,500

Did anybody find four?

21

00:00:49,500 --> 00:00:50,960

Anybody find only five Fs?

22

00:00:50,960 --> 00:00:51,780

Anybody find six?

23

00:00:51,780 --> 00:00:52,760

Theres six Fs.

24

00:00:52,760 --> 00:00:56,560

What two letter word ending in F did many of us miss?

25

00:00:56,560 --> 00:00:58,439

Oh, well make sure to get this to you

26

00:00:58,439 --> 00:01:00,540

so you can torment your friends and family.

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00:01:00,000 --> 00:01:04,200

at a later date. When I first was exposed to this over 12 years ago, I only found

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00:01:04,200 --> 00:01:07,859

READ, and I felt really stupid. So I like to start every workshop, every class I

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00:01:07,859 --> 00:01:11,000

teach with this, to pass that feeling along. Thats not why I do this.

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00:01:11,000 --> 00:01:14,460

I do this because this is a perfect analogy for what were going to be talking

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00:01:14,460 --> 00:01:17,900

about. The vast majority of us in this room, very smart people in this room, were not

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00:01:17,900 --> 00:01:20,560

as effective as we could have been in this act. We didnt get it right. And the

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00:01:20,560 --> 00:01:24,460

same is true when it comes to speaking in public, particularly when spontaneous.

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00:01:24,460 --> 00:01:27,960

Its little things that make a big difference in being effective. So today

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00:01:27,960 --> 00:01:32,039

were going to talk about little things in terms of

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00:01:30,000 --> 00:01:34,260

your approach, your attitude, your practice that can change how you feel when you speak

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00:01:34,260 --> 00:01:38,019

in public. Were going to be talking primarily about one type of public speech, not the type

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00:01:38,019 --> 00:01:41,579

that you plan for in advance, the type that you actually spend time thinking about, you

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00:01:41,579 --> 00:01:45,680

might even create slides for. These are the keynotes, the conference presentation, the

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00:01:45,680 --> 00:01:49,900

formal toasts. That's not what we were talking about. We were talking about spontaneous speak.

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00:01:49,920 --> 00:01:53,780

When you're in a situation that you're asked to speak off the cuff and in the moment. What

42

00:01:53,780 --> 00:01:57,560

were going through today is actually the result of a workshop I created here for the

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00:01:57,560 --> 00:02:00,040

business school. Several years ago, a survey was taken.

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00:02:00,000 --> 00:02:03,680

the students and they said what's one of what are things we could do to help make you more successful

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00:02:03,680 --> 00:02:07,920

and at the top of that list was this notion of responding cold call does everybody know what a

46

00:02:07,920 --> 00:02:11,360

cold call is where the mean professor like me looks at some students what do you think and

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00:02:11,360 --> 00:02:15,520

there was a lot of a lot of so as a result of that this workshop was created and a vast majority of

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00:02:15,520 --> 00:02:19,120

first-year students here at the gsb go through this so im going to walk through sort of a

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00:02:19,120 --> 00:02:24,159

hybrid version what they the reality is that spontaneous speaking is actually more prevalent

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00:02:24,159 --> 00:02:27,840

than plants perhaps its giving introductions youre at a dinner and somebody says you know

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00:02:27,840 --> 00:02:29,920

so and so would you mind maybe its giving

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00:02:30,000 --> 00:02:33,319

feedback in the moment. Your boss turns to you and says, tell me what day. It could be a surprise

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00:02:33,319 --> 00:02:36,919

toast. Or finally, it could be during the Q&A session. And by the way, we will leave plenty

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00:02:36,919 --> 00:02:40,800

of time at the end of our day for Q&A. Id love to hear the question about this topic or other

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00:02:40,800 --> 00:02:45,639

topics. So our agenda is simple. In order to be an effective communicator, regardless of if its

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00:02:45,639 --> 00:02:50,520

planned or spontaneous, you need to have your anxiety. So well start there. Second, what were

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00:02:50,520 --> 00:02:54,780

going to talk about is some ground rules for the interactivity well have today. And then finally,

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00:02:54,780 --> 00:02:58,460

were going to get into the heart, what were covering. And again, as I said, lots of activity

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00:02:58,460 --> 00:02:59,960

and I invite you. So lets get started with.

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00:03:00,000 --> 00:03:04,360

anxiety management. 85% of people tell us that theyre nervous when speaking in public, and I

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00:03:04,360 --> 00:03:08,719

think the other 15% are lying. We could create a situation where we could make them nervous. In

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00:03:08,719 --> 00:03:13,259

fact, just this past week, a study from Chapman University asked Americans, what are the things

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00:03:13,259 --> 00:03:17,900

you fear most? And among being caught in a surprise terrorist attack, having your identity

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00:03:17,900 --> 00:03:22,479

stolen was public speaking. Among the top five was speaking in front of others. This is a ubiquitous

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00:03:22,479 --> 00:03:26,340

fear and one that I believe we can learn to manage. And I use that word manage very carefully

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00:03:26,340 --> 00:03:29,900

because I don't think we ever want to overcome it. Anxiety actually helps us. It gives us.

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00:03:30,000 --> 00:03:33,500

Energy helps us focus, tells us what we're doing is important, but we want to learn manners.

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00:03:33,539 --> 00:03:37,879

So I'd like to introduce you to a few techniques that can work, and all of these techniques are based on academicism.

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00:03:37,919 --> 00:03:43,199

But before we get there, I'd love to ask you, what does it feel like when you're sitting in the audience watching a nervous speaker present?

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00:03:43,219 --> 00:03:44,719

How do you feel? Just shout out, how do you feel?

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00:03:45,300 --> 00:03:47,319

Uncomfortable. I heard many of you going, yes, uncomfortable.

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00:03:47,360 --> 00:03:48,740

It feels very awkward, doesn't it?

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00:03:48,740 --> 00:03:52,319

So what do we do? Now, a couple of you probably like watching somebody suffer, okay?

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00:03:52,379 --> 00:03:54,420

But most of us don't. So what do we do?

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00:03:54,520 --> 00:03:57,539

We sit there and we nod, smile, or we disengage.

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00:03:57,539 --> 00:03:59,979

And to the nervous speaker looking out at his or her audience,

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00:04:00,000 --> 00:04:03,520

seeing a bunch of people nodding or disengage, that does not help. So we need to learn to manage

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00:04:03,520 --> 00:04:07,139

our anxieties. Fundamentally, your job as a communicator, rather, regardless of if its

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00:04:07,139 --> 00:04:10,520

planned or spontaneous, is to make your audience comfortable. Because if theyre comfortable,

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00:04:10,620 --> 00:04:14,680

they can receive your message. And when I say comfortable, I am not referring to the fact that

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00:04:14,680 --> 00:04:19,040

your message has to be sugar-coated and nice for them here. It can be a harsh message, but they

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00:04:19,040 --> 00:04:22,959

have to be in a place where they can receive. So its incumbent on you as a communicator to help

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00:04:22,959 --> 00:04:26,540

your audience feel comfortable. We do that by managing our anxiety. So let me introduce you

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00:04:26,540 --> 00:04:29,959

to a few techniques that I think you can use right away to help you feel.

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00:04:30,000 --> 00:04:33,920

more comfortable. The first has to do with when you begin to feel those anxieties. And for most

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00:04:33,920 --> 00:04:38,759

people, this happens in the initial minutes prior to speak. In this situation, what happens is many

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00:04:38,759 --> 00:04:43,040

of us begin to feel whatever it is that happens to you. Maybe your stomach gets a little gurgly.

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00:04:43,199 --> 00:04:47,199

Maybe your legs begin to shake. Maybe you aspire. And then we start to say to ourselves, oh my

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00:04:47,199 --> 00:04:51,199

goodness, I'm nervous. -oh, they're going to tell I'm nervous. This is not going to go well.

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00:04:51,220 --> 00:04:56,180

And we start spiraling out of it. So research on mindful attention tells us that if when we begin

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00:04:56,180 --> 00:04:59,980

to feel those anxieties, we simply greet our anxiety and say, hey, this is

92

00:05:00,000 --> 00:05:04,620

me feeling nervous. I'm about to do something of consequence. And simply by greeting your anxiety

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00:05:04,620 --> 00:05:08,959

and acknowledging that its normal and natural. Heck, 85% of people tell us they have it. You

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00:05:08,959 --> 00:05:13,120

actually can stem the tide of that anxiety spiraling out. Its not necessarily going to

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00:05:13,120 --> 00:05:17,160

reduce the anxiety, but it will stop it from spinning up. So the next time you begin to feel

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00:05:17,160 --> 00:05:21,120

those anxiety signs, take a deep breath and say, this is me. I notice a few of you take some notes.

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00:05:21,180 --> 00:05:25,000

Theres a handout that has everything that Im supposed to say. Okay. Cant guarantee Im going

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00:05:25,000 --> 00:05:28,800

to say it, but youll have it. In addition to this approach, a technique that works very well,

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00:05:28,800 --> 00:05:30,000

and this is a technique that I

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00:05:30,000 --> 00:05:34,199

helped do some research on way back my grads has to do with reframing how see

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00:05:34,199 --> 00:05:37,879

this most of us when we are up presenting planned or spontaneous we

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00:05:37,879 --> 00:05:41,759

feel that we have to do it right and we feel like we are performing how many of

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00:05:41,759 --> 00:05:44,759

you have ever acted and singing or dancing Im not gonna ask performance

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00:05:44,759 --> 00:05:48,060

many of you have we should note that we could do next year maybe a talent show

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00:05:48,060 --> 00:05:51,360

of alums it looks like we got talent great so when you perform you know that

106

00:05:51,360 --> 00:05:54,300

theres a right way in a wrong way to do it you dont hit your the right note or

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00:05:54,300 --> 00:05:57,899

your right line the right time the right place made us it messes up the audience

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00:05:57,899 --> 00:06:02,019

it messes up people but when you present is no

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00:06:00,000 --> 00:06:03,240

right way theres certainly better and worse ways but is no one so we need to

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00:06:03,240 --> 00:06:06,180

look at presenting is something other than performance and what Id like to

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00:06:06,180 --> 00:06:09,540

suggest what we need to see this as a conversation right now Im having a

112

00:06:09,540 --> 00:06:12,720

conversation with a hundred plus rather than saying Im but its not enough just

113

00:06:12,720 --> 00:06:16,680

to say this is a conversation I want to give you some concrete things first start

114

00:06:16,680 --> 00:06:20,699

with quest questions by their very nature are dialogic two-way what was one

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00:06:20,699 --> 00:06:23,759

of the very first things I did here for you I had you count the number of Fs

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00:06:23,759 --> 00:06:27,300

and raise your ass quest that gets your audience involved it makes it feel to me

117

00:06:27,300 --> 00:06:31,879

as presenter as if we are in comes to use question

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00:06:30,000 --> 00:06:31,000

be rhetorical.

119

00:06:31,000 --> 00:06:32,000

Theyre polling.

120

00:06:32,000 --> 00:06:33,000

Perhaps I actually want to hear information.

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00:06:33,000 --> 00:06:35,879

In fact, I use questions when I create and outline my presentation.

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00:06:35,879 --> 00:06:39,339

Rather than writing bullet points, I list questions that Im going to answer.

123

00:06:39,339 --> 00:06:40,560

That puts me in that conversation.

124

00:06:40,560 --> 00:06:44,079

If you were to look at my notes for today's talk, you'll see it's just a series of questions.

125

00:06:44,079 --> 00:06:46,480

Right now, I'm answering the question, how do we manage our anxiety?

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00:06:46,480 --> 00:06:51,439

Beyond questions, another very useful technique for making us conversational is to use conversational

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00:06:51,439 --> 00:06:52,439

language.

128

00:06:52,439 --> 00:06:54,519

Many nervous speakers distance themselves physically.

129

00:06:54,519 --> 00:06:56,120

You've ever seen a nervous speaker present?

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00:06:56,120 --> 00:06:59,759

He or she will say something like this, welcome, I am really excited to be here with you.

131

00:06:59,759 --> 00:07:00,759

They .

132

00:07:00,000 --> 00:07:04,079

as far away from you as possible because you threaten us. You make us nervous. We want to get

133

00:07:00,759 --> 00:07:01,759

You're welcome.

134

00:07:01,759 --> 00:07:02,759

Thanks for listening.

135

00:07:02,759 --> 00:07:03,759

I appreciate the opportunity to talk to you.

136

00:07:03,759 --> 00:07:04,759

Thank you.

137

00:07:04,079 --> 00:07:08,300

away. We do the same thing linguists. We use language that just. It's not unusual to hear

138

00:07:04,759 --> 00:07:05,759

See you next time.

139

00:07:05,759 --> 00:07:06,759

Bye.

140

00:07:06,759 --> 00:07:07,759

Bye.

141

00:07:07,759 --> 00:07:08,759

Bye.

142

00:07:08,300 --> 00:07:12,839

a nervous speaker say something like, one must consider the ramifications or today were going

143

00:07:08,759 --> 00:07:09,759

Take care.

144

00:07:09,759 --> 00:07:10,759

Bye.

145

00:07:10,759 --> 00:07:11,759

Bye.

146

00:07:11,759 --> 00:07:12,759

Bye.

147

00:07:12,759 --> 00:07:13,759

Bye.

148

00:07:12,839 --> 00:07:16,699

to cover step one, step two, step. Its very distancing. To be more conversational, use

149

00:07:13,759 --> 00:07:14,759

Bye.

150

00:07:14,759 --> 00:07:15,759

Bye.

151

00:07:15,759 --> 00:07:16,759

Bye.

152

00:07:16,699 --> 00:07:20,240

conversational language. Instead of one must consider, say this is important to you. We all

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00:07:16,759 --> 00:07:17,759

Bye.

154

00:07:17,759 --> 00:07:18,759

Bye.

155

00:07:18,759 --> 00:07:19,759

Bye.

156

00:07:19,759 --> 00:07:20,759

Bye.

157

00:07:20,240 --> 00:07:23,660

need to be concerned with. You hear that inclusive conversational language. It has to do with.

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00:07:20,759 --> 00:07:21,759

Bye.

159

00:07:21,759 --> 00:07:22,759

Bye.

160

00:07:22,759 --> 00:07:23,759

Bye.

161

00:07:23,660 --> 00:07:27,519

Instead of step one, step two, step three. First, what we need to do is this. The second thing you

162

00:07:23,759 --> 00:07:24,759

Bye.

163

00:07:24,759 --> 00:07:25,759

Bye.

164

00:07:25,759 --> 00:07:26,759

Bye.

165

00:07:26,759 --> 00:07:27,759

Bye.

166

00:07:27,519 --> 00:07:30,040

should consider is use conversation. So being conversational.

167

00:07:27,759 --> 00:07:28,759

Bye.

168

00:07:28,759 --> 00:07:29,759

Bye.

169

00:07:30,000 --> 00:07:34,439

conversational can also help you manage. The third technique I'd like to share is research that I

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00:07:34,439 --> 00:07:38,160

actually started when I was an undergraduate. I was very fortunate to study with Phil Zimbardo,

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00:07:38,259 --> 00:07:43,319

the Stanford experiment. Many people don't know that Zim actually was instrumental in starting

172

00:07:43,319 --> 00:07:47,540

one of the very first shyness institutes in the world, especially. And I did some research with

173

00:07:47,540 --> 00:07:52,660

him that looked at how your orientation to time influences how you react. And what we learned is

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00:07:52,660 --> 00:07:56,860

if you can bring yourself into the present moment, rather than being worried about future consequences,

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00:07:56,860 --> 00:07:59,939

you can actually be less. Most of us, when we present are worried.

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00:08:00,000 --> 00:08:01,259

about future consequences.

177

00:08:01,259 --> 00:08:03,180

My students are worried they're not gonna get the right grade.

178

00:08:03,180 --> 00:08:05,000

Some of you are worried you might not get funding,

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00:08:05,000 --> 00:08:07,079

might not get the support, you might not get the laughs.

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00:08:07,079 --> 00:08:08,579

All of those are future states.

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00:08:08,579 --> 00:08:10,920

So if we can bring ourselves into the present moment,

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00:08:10,920 --> 00:08:13,000

were not going to be as concerned about this for states,

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00:08:13,000 --> 00:08:14,000

therefore well be lessened.

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00:08:14,000 --> 00:08:15,240

Lots of ways to become present-oriented.

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00:08:15,240 --> 00:08:16,660

I know a professional speaker.

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00:08:16,660 --> 00:08:19,060

Hes paid \$10,000 an hour to speak.

187

00:08:19,060 --> 00:08:19,899

Good gig.

188

00:08:19,899 --> 00:08:20,740

He gets very nervous.

189

00:08:20,740 --> 00:08:21,579

Hes up in front of crowds of thousands.

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00:08:21,579 --> 00:08:23,899

Behind the stage does 100 push-ups right before hes out.

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00:08:23,899 --> 00:08:25,439

You cant be that physically active

192

00:08:25,439 --> 00:08:26,360

and not be in the present moment.

193

00:08:26,360 --> 00:08:27,720

Now Im not recommending all of us

194

00:08:27,720 --> 00:08:28,899

go to that level of exertion,

195

00:08:28,899 --> 00:08:30,560

because he starts out of breath.

196

00:08:30,000 --> 00:08:33,600

sweating but a walk around the building before you speak back there are other ways if youve

197

00:08:33,600 --> 00:08:37,440

ever watched athletes form get ready do their event they listen to music they focus on a song

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00:08:37,440 --> 00:08:40,720

or a playlist that helps get them you can do things as simple as counting backwards from

199

00:08:40,720 --> 00:08:44,799

a hundred by tough numbers like 17. im gonna pause i know people in the room are crying now

200

00:08:44,799 --> 00:08:48,879

gets hard after that third or fourth one i know my favorite way to get present oriented is to say

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00:08:48,879 --> 00:08:52,559

tongue twist saying a tongue twister forces you to be in the moment otherwise you'll say it wrong

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00:08:52,559 --> 00:08:56,960

and it has the added benefit of warming up your voice most nervous speakers don't warm up their

203

00:08:56,960 --> 00:09:00,000

voice they retreat inside themselves and start saying all these bad things so saying

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00:09:00,000 --> 00:09:03,399

a tongue twister can help you be full present oriented and warm up your voice. Remember I said

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00:09:03,399 --> 00:09:06,320

today we're going to have a lot of participation. I'm going to ask you to repeat after me my favorite

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00:09:06,320 --> 00:09:10,159

tongues. And I like this tongue twister because say it wrong, say a naughty word. And I'm going

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00:09:10,159 --> 00:09:13,480

to be listening to see if I hear any naughty words this morning. Repeat after me. It's only

208

00:09:13,480 --> 00:09:20,100

three phrases. I slit a sheet. A sheet I slit. And on that slitted sheet I sit. Very good. No shits.

209

00:09:20,299 --> 00:09:25,580

Excellent. Very good. Now in that moment, in that moment, you weren't worried about I'm in front of

210

00:09:25,580 --> 00:09:29,980

all these people. This is weird. This guy's having me. You were so focused on saying it right. And

211

00:09:29,980 --> 00:09:59,960

you're like, I'm in front of all these people. And you're like, I'm in front of all these people.

212

00:09:30,000 --> 00:09:33,379

trying to figure out what the naughty word was that you were in the present. That's how easy it is.

213

00:09:33,460 --> 00:09:38,679

So it's very possible for us to manage our anxiety. We can do it initially by greeting the anxiety

214

00:09:38,679 --> 00:09:43,139

when we begin to feel those signs. We can do it when we reframe the situation as a conversation

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00:09:43,139 --> 00:09:47,759

and we do it when we become present. Those are three of many tools that exist to help you manage

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00:09:47,759 --> 00:09:50,940

your anxiety. If you have questions about other ways, I'm happy to chat. And at the end, I'm going

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00:09:50,940 --> 00:09:54,840

to point you to some resources you can refer to to help you find additional sources. So lets get

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00:09:54,840 --> 00:09:58,320

started on the core part of what were doing today, which is how to feel more comfortable

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00:09:58,320 --> 00:09:59,899

speaking in spontaneous. Some very.

220

00:10:00,000 --> 00:10:04,440

simple ground rules for you. First, Im going to identify four steps that I believe are critical

221

00:10:04,440 --> 00:10:08,080

to becoming effective at speaking spontaneously. With each of those steps, Im going to ask you

222

00:10:08,080 --> 00:10:10,899

to participate in an activity. None of them are more painful than saying,

223

00:10:10,980 --> 00:10:14,659

they may require you to stand up, they might require you to talk to the person next to you,

224

00:10:14,720 --> 00:10:18,620

but none of them are. And then finally, Im going to conclude with a phrase or saying that comes

225

00:10:18,620 --> 00:10:22,460

from the wonderful world of improvisation. Through the Continuing Studies program here

226

00:10:22,460 --> 00:10:26,500

at Stanford for the past five years, I have co-taught a class with Adam Tobin. He is a

227

00:10:26,500 --> 00:10:29,799

lecturer in the creative arts department. He does film, new media.

228

00:10:30,000 --> 00:10:31,080

And hes an expert at improv.

229

00:10:31,259 --> 00:10:34,379

And weve partnered together to help people learn how to speak more spontaneously.

230

00:10:34,539 --> 00:10:36,100

Call it improvisationally speak.

231

00:10:36,200 --> 00:10:41,500

And Adam has taught me wonderful phrases and ideas from improv that I want to impart to you that really stick.

232

00:10:41,580 --> 00:10:42,259

Thats why Im sharing.

233

00:10:42,340 --> 00:10:43,460

Help you remember these texts.

234

00:10:43,539 --> 00:10:45,799

And again, at the end of all this, youll get a handout that has this.

235

00:10:45,840 --> 00:10:46,600

So lets get started.

236

00:10:46,679 --> 00:10:50,899

The very first thing that gets in peoples way when it comes to spontaneous speak is themselves.

237

00:10:51,159 --> 00:10:52,480

We get in our own way.

238

00:10:52,519 --> 00:10:53,279

We want to be perfect.

239

00:10:53,320 --> 00:10:54,659

We want to give the right answer.

240

00:10:54,759 --> 00:10:56,679

We want our toast to be incredibly memorable.

241

00:10:56,679 --> 00:10:59,059

These things are burdened by our effort.

242

00:10:59,159 --> 00:10:59,879

By our mind.

243

00:11:00,000 --> 00:11:04,700

best thing we can do, the first step in our process, get ourselves out. Easier said than

244

00:11:04,700 --> 00:11:09,240

done. Most of us in this room are in this room because we are type A personalities. We work hard,

245

00:11:09,320 --> 00:11:14,480

we think fast, we make sure that we get. But that can actually serve as a disservice as we try to

246

00:11:14,480 --> 00:11:17,340

speak. I'd like to demonstrate this for you and your health. So we're going to do our first

247

00:11:17,340 --> 00:11:21,360

activity. We are going to do an activity that's called shout the wrong name. In a moment, if you

248

00:11:21,360 --> 00:11:25,779

are able and willing, I'm going to ask Stan and I'm going to ask you for about 30 seconds to look

249

00:11:25,779 --> 00:11:29,480

all around you in this environment. And you are going to point at different things. And I know

250

00:11:29,480 --> 00:11:30,000

it's rude point.

251

00:11:30,000 --> 00:11:33,759

this exercise, please point. I want you to point to things and you are going to call the things you

252

00:11:33,759 --> 00:11:37,759

are pointing to out loud anything but what they really are. So I might point to this and say

253

00:11:37,759 --> 00:11:42,919

refrigerator. I might point to this and say cat. I am pointing to anything in your environment

254

00:11:42,919 --> 00:11:46,720

around and be the person sitting next standing. You will just shout and shouting is important.

255

00:11:46,840 --> 00:11:50,879

The wrong name. So in a moment, Im going to ask you to stand. Please raise your hand if you already

256

00:11:50,879 --> 00:11:54,779

have the first five or six things youre going to call out. Yeah, thats what Im talking about.

257

00:11:54,860 --> 00:11:59,500

We stop high. You all are excellent game players. I told you the game. Shout the wrong name and you

258

00:11:59,500 --> 00:11:59,980

have already.

259

00:12:00,000 --> 00:12:04,419

begun figuring out how youre going to master thats your brain trying to help you get it right

260

00:12:04,419 --> 00:12:08,820

id like to suggest the only way you can get this activity wrong is by doing what youve just done

261

00:12:08,820 --> 00:12:14,399

there is no way to get this wrong okay even if i call this a chair no penalty will be bestowed upon

262

00:12:14,399 --> 00:12:17,399

you okay because i wont know what you were pointing at you could have been pointing at the

263

00:12:17,399 --> 00:12:21,679

floor under the chair and you called the floor the chair and you were fine the point is we are

264

00:12:21,679 --> 00:12:26,779

planning and working get it right and there is no way get it right just doing gets okay so lets try

265

00:12:26,779 --> 00:12:30,019

this now were going to play this game twice again 30 seconds if you are willing and

266

00:12:30,000 --> 00:12:33,240

enable, will you please stand up? You can do this seated, by the way, but if youre willing and

267

00:12:33,240 --> 00:12:38,259

able, lets stand up. Okay, in a moment, I am about to say go, and I would like for you to point at

268

00:12:38,259 --> 00:12:42,799

anything around here, including me. Its okay to point at me. I hope its not a bad thing you say

269

00:12:42,799 --> 00:12:46,759

when you point at me, but point at different things and loudly and proudly call them different

270

00:12:46,759 --> 00:12:54,419

than what they are. Ready? Begin! Porcupine, California, Salt Shaker, Car, Library, Tennis

271

00:12:54,419 --> 00:13:00,059

Racket, Purple, Orange, Putrid, Hello, Time, Time.

272

00:13:00,000 --> 00:13:04,980

time. Lets, you can stay standing because in a mere moments, were going to do it again. So if

273

00:13:04,980 --> 00:13:08,419

youre comfortable standing, were about to do it again. First, thank you. That was wonderful. I

274

00:13:08,419 --> 00:13:12,179

heard great words being called out. It was, it was fun. And some of you in the back were doing

275

00:13:12,179 --> 00:13:16,360

it in sync. So it looked like you were doing some seventies disco dance. It was awesome. Okay. This,

276

00:13:16,539 --> 00:13:20,659

this was great. Now let me ask just a few questions. Did you notice anything about the

277

00:13:20,659 --> 00:13:25,159

words that you were saying? Did we find patterns perhaps? Maybe some of you were going through

278

00:13:25,159 --> 00:13:29,960

fruits and vegetables. A few of you were going through things that started with the letter A.

279

00:13:30,000 --> 00:13:34,899

right thats your brain saying okay you told me not to stockpile so im going to try to be a little

280

00:13:34,899 --> 00:13:40,279

more devious and im going to give you patterns okay same problem when we teach that class i told

281

00:13:40,279 --> 00:13:44,120

you about that improvisationally speak class we like to say your brain is there to help you these

282

00:13:44,120 --> 00:13:48,059

things its doing have helped you be successful but like a windshield wiper we just want to wipe

283

00:13:48,059 --> 00:13:52,559

those suggestions away and see what happens so were going to do this activity again this time

284

00:13:52,559 --> 00:13:56,740

try the best hand to thank your brain if it provides you with pattern or stockpiles and to

285

00:13:56,740 --> 00:14:00,000

say thank you brain and disregard okay so lets see what happens when were

286

00:14:00,000 --> 00:14:04,320

not stockpiling and were not playing off pattern. Well do this for only 15 secs. See how this feels.

287

00:14:04,379 --> 00:14:13,919

Baby steps. Ready? Begin. Kodak. Bicycle chain. Skateboard. Bananas. Purple. Putrid. Time. Please

288

00:14:13,919 --> 00:14:19,960

have a seat. Thank you again. Did you notice a difference between the second time and the first

289

00:14:19,960 --> 00:14:25,879

time? Yes. Was it a little easier that second time? No. Thats okay. Were just starting. These skills

290

00:14:25,879 --> 00:14:29,919

are not like a light switch. Its not like you learn these skills and then all of a sudden

291

00:14:29,919 --> 00:14:30,019

you.

292

00:14:30,000 --> 00:14:34,220

you can execute. This is a wonderful game. This is a wonderful game. Train your brain to get out

293

00:14:34,220 --> 00:14:38,399

of its own way. You can play this game anywhere, anytime. I like to play this game when Im sitting

294

00:14:38,399 --> 00:14:41,879

in traffic. It makes me feel better. I shout things out. They're not the naughty things that

295

00:14:41,879 --> 00:14:45,480

I want to be shouting out, but I shout out things and it helps. You're training yourself to get out

296

00:14:45,480 --> 00:14:49,139

of it. You're working against the muscle memory that you've developed over the course of your

297

00:14:49,139 --> 00:14:53,039

life with a brain that acts very fast to help solve problems. But in essence, in spontaneous

298

00:14:53,039 --> 00:14:57,039

speaking situations, you put too much pressure on yourself trying to figure out how to get it

299

00:14:57,039 --> 00:14:59,919

right. So a game like this teaches us get out of our own. It teaches.

300

00:15:00,000 --> 00:15:05,620

us to see things that we do that prevent us from acting spontaneously. In essence, we are reacting

301

00:15:05,620 --> 00:15:10,019

rather than responding. To react means to act again. Thought it, and now you're acting on it.

302

00:15:10,039 --> 00:15:14,100

That takes too long, and its taught. We want to respond in a way thats genuine and authentic.

303

00:15:14,200 --> 00:15:17,659

So the maxim I would like for you to take from this, and again, these maxims come from

304

00:15:17,659 --> 00:15:21,919

improvisation. One of my favorites, dare be dull. And in a room like this, telling you dare to be

305

00:15:21,919 --> 00:15:27,480

dull is offensive, and I apologize. But this will help. Rather than striving for greatness, dare to

306

00:15:27,480 --> 00:15:29,899

be dull. And if you dare to be dull, allow yourself that.

307

00:15:30,000 --> 00:15:33,759

will reach that grace. Its when you set greatness as your target that it gets in the way of you

308

00:15:33,759 --> 00:15:37,620

ever getting it. Because you over-evaluate, you over-analyze, you freeze up. So the first step

309

00:15:37,620 --> 00:15:41,960

in our process there is to get out of our own dare to be dull. Easier said than done. But once

310

00:15:41,960 --> 00:15:45,220

you practice, a game just as simple as the one we practice is a great way. That's not enough.

311

00:15:45,279 --> 00:15:49,259

Getting out of our own way is important. The second step of our process has us change how we

312

00:15:49,259 --> 00:15:53,960

see the situation and find ourselves. We need to see the speaking opportunity that we are a part

313

00:15:53,960 --> 00:15:59,559

of as an opportunity rather than a challenge and a threat. When I coach executives on Q&A skills,

314

00:15:59,559 --> 00:15:59,980

when they go

315

00:16:00,000 --> 00:16:01,220

in front of the media or whatever.

316

00:16:01,460 --> 00:16:05,120

They see it as an adversarial experience, me versus them.

317

00:16:05,200 --> 00:16:06,860

And one of the first things I work on

318

00:16:06,860 --> 00:16:08,340

is change the way you approach.

319

00:16:08,419 --> 00:16:10,500

A Q&A session, for example, is an opportunity.

320

00:16:10,580 --> 00:16:11,360

Its an opportunity to clarify.

321

00:16:11,539 --> 00:16:12,700

Its an opportunity to understand what learned.

322

00:16:12,740 --> 00:16:14,460

So if we look at it as an opportunity,

323

00:16:14,539 --> 00:16:15,700

it feels very different.

324

00:16:15,740 --> 00:16:16,639

We see it differently,

325

00:16:16,779 --> 00:16:18,419

and therefore we have more freedom to respond.

326

00:16:18,500 --> 00:16:20,220

When I feel that you are challenging me,

327

00:16:20,299 --> 00:16:21,740

I am going to do the bare minimum

328

00:16:21,740 --> 00:16:23,220

to respond and protect myself.

329

00:16:23,240 --> 00:16:24,659

If I see this as an opportunity

330

00:16:24,659 --> 00:16:26,659

where I have a chance to explain and expand,

331

00:16:26,799 --> 00:16:27,779

Im going to interact differently.

332

00:16:27,779 --> 00:16:29,980

So spontaneous speaking situations

333

00:16:30,000 --> 00:16:33,399

are ones that afford op. So when youre at a corporate dinner and your boss turns to you and

334

00:16:33,399 --> 00:16:37,059

says, oh, you know him better than the rest. Do you mind introducing him? You say, great,

335

00:16:37,139 --> 00:16:42,240

thank you for the opportunity. Rather than, right, I better get this right. So see things as an op.

336

00:16:42,240 --> 00:16:46,019

Have a gameplay. Help us. This is a fun one. The holidays are approaching. We all in this room are

337

00:16:46,019 --> 00:16:50,240

going to give and receive gifts. Heres how this game will work. It works best if you have a part.

338

00:16:50,320 --> 00:16:53,759

So Im hoping you can work with somebody sitting next. If theres nobody sitting next, turn around,

339

00:16:53,840 --> 00:16:57,080

introduce yourself. Great way to connect. If not, you can play this game by yourself. Its just a

340

00:16:57,080 --> 00:16:59,960

little harder and you cant. The second part. So after I explain the game, give this.

341

00:17:00,000 --> 00:17:02,919

gives you a chance to get some. Heres how it works. If you have a partner, you and your partner

342

00:17:02,919 --> 00:17:07,200

are going to exchange imaginary gifts. Pretend you have a gift, a big gift, a small gift, and you

343

00:17:07,200 --> 00:17:11,279

will give your gift to your partner. Your partner will take gift and open it up and will tell you

344

00:17:11,279 --> 00:17:14,819

what you gave them because you have not, you just gave them a gift. So you are going to open up the

345

00:17:14,819 --> 00:17:18,400

box and youre going to look inside and you are going to say the first thing that comes to your

346

00:17:18,400 --> 00:17:22,660

mind in the moment, not the thing you have all just thought of or the thing after that. Remember

347

00:17:22,660 --> 00:17:26,440

what we talked about before? That still plays. Thats still in play. Okay. Youre stockpiling.

348

00:17:26,440 --> 00:17:29,980

Look in there. My favorite that I said, somebody gave me this a gift during playing this.

349

00:17:30,000 --> 00:17:34,779

game i looked inside and i saw a frog leg i dont know why i saw a frog leg thats what i said thats

350

00:17:34,779 --> 00:17:39,940

the first part of the activity now the opportunity is twofold in this game the opportunity is for you

351

00:17:39,940 --> 00:17:43,819

the gift receiver to name a gift thats kind of fun thats an op not a rat but the real opportunity

352

00:17:43,819 --> 00:17:47,539

is for the gift giver because the gift giver then has to say so you look and you say thank you for

353

00:17:47,539 --> 00:17:52,059

giving me a frogs leg and the person will look at you say i knew you wanted a frogs leg because

354

00:17:52,059 --> 00:17:58,319

so whatever you find the person who has received it is going to say absolutely im so glad youre

355

00:17:58,319 --> 00:17:59,980

happy i got it for you because

356

00:18:00,000 --> 00:18:02,680

So you have to respond to whatever they say, right?

357

00:18:02,759 --> 00:18:03,680

What a great opportunity.

358

00:18:03,839 --> 00:18:04,839

Now, some of you are sitting there going,

359

00:18:04,920 --> 00:18:05,519

oh, thats hard.

360

00:18:05,579 --> 00:18:06,359

I dont want to do it by myself.

361

00:18:06,460 --> 00:18:08,279

Others of you are, if youre following this advice,

362

00:18:08,359 --> 00:18:09,759

are saying, what a great opportunity, right?

363

00:18:09,819 --> 00:18:11,400

So the game again is played like this.

364

00:18:11,460 --> 00:18:12,779

You and your partner will exchange.

365

00:18:12,859 --> 00:18:13,700

Each will exchange a gift.

366

00:18:13,740 --> 00:18:14,799

One will start and the other will follow.

367

00:18:14,839 --> 00:18:16,579

First person will give a gift to the second person.

368

00:18:16,660 --> 00:18:18,960

Second person opens the box, however big the box is.

369

00:18:19,019 --> 00:18:21,180

And if the box is big and you find a penny in it,

370

00:18:21,220 --> 00:18:22,059

perfect, doesnt matter.

371

00:18:22,180 --> 00:18:24,220

The box is heavy and you find a feather in it, fine.

372

00:18:24,299 --> 00:18:25,559

It does, theres no way to get it wrong, okay?

373

00:18:25,680 --> 00:18:26,900

Whatevers in the box is in the box.

374

00:18:26,900 --> 00:18:28,859

You can return it and get what you wanted later.

375

00:18:29,019 --> 00:18:30,000

The person that.

376

00:18:30,000 --> 00:18:34,279

you will name it youll say thank you for the whatever you saw in the box the person who gave

377

00:18:34,279 --> 00:18:38,839

it to you will say im so glad youre excited i got it for you because and you will give a reason

378

00:18:38,839 --> 00:18:42,880

that you got them whatever they decided gave make sense all right so very quickly just in five

379

00:18:42,880 --> 00:18:46,259

seconds find a partner if youre willing to do this with a partner everybody have a partner okay

380

00:18:46,259 --> 00:18:53,140

all right in your partnerships in your partnerships pick an a person and a b person you may stand or

381

00:18:53,140 --> 00:18:59,880

its totally up to you pick an a and pick a b okay b goes first ha ha ha all right

382

00:19:00,000 --> 00:19:01,220

B, give A a gift.

383

00:19:01,339 --> 00:19:02,359

B, give A a gift.

384

00:19:02,480 --> 00:19:03,480

A, thank them.

385

00:19:03,680 --> 00:19:06,420

And then B will name and give the reason they gave it to them.

386

00:19:06,480 --> 00:19:08,980

If you have not switched, switch, please.

387

00:19:09,220 --> 00:19:11,279

If you have not switched, switch, please.

388

00:19:11,539 --> 00:19:14,460

Lets wrap it up in 30 seconds, please.

389

00:19:14,680 --> 00:19:15,240

Wrap it up.

390

00:19:15,380 --> 00:19:16,319

All right.

391

00:19:16,380 --> 00:19:17,859

If we can all have our seats.

392

00:19:18,400 --> 00:19:20,619

If we can all take our seats, please.

393

00:19:21,420 --> 00:19:26,279

I know Im telling a room of many MBA alums to stop talking, and thats hard.

394

00:19:26,279 --> 00:19:29,680

All right, ladies and gentlemen, did you get what you wanted?

395

00:19:29,680 --> 00:19:29,819

I did.

396

00:19:30,000 --> 00:19:30,839

Pretty neat, huh?

397

00:19:31,000 --> 00:19:32,119

You always get what you want.

398

00:19:32,200 --> 00:19:34,140

Now, for some of you, this was really hard

399

00:19:34,140 --> 00:19:36,400

because you were really taking the challenge

400

00:19:36,400 --> 00:19:38,059

and not seeing what was in the box.

401

00:19:38,339 --> 00:19:41,140

Was anybody surprised by what you found in the box?

402

00:19:41,279 --> 00:19:42,079

What did you find, sir?

403

00:19:42,119 --> 00:19:42,839

What was in the box?

404

00:19:43,440 --> 00:19:46,019

Wow, nice, nice.

405

00:19:46,180 --> 00:19:47,920

If youve got a Ferrari, you need a transmission.

406

00:19:48,099 --> 00:19:48,500

I like it.

407

00:19:48,539 --> 00:19:49,980

Who else found something that was surprising?

408

00:19:50,059 --> 00:19:50,700

What did you find?

409

00:19:50,759 --> 00:19:51,819

A live unicorn.

410

00:19:52,160 --> 00:19:53,160

Thats a great gift, right?

411

00:19:53,220 --> 00:19:54,940

How was it as the gift giver?

412

00:19:54,940 --> 00:19:57,660

Were you surprised at what your partner found in the box?

413

00:19:57,660 --> 00:20:00,140

Isnt it interesting that when we give an imagine.

414

00:20:00,000 --> 00:20:03,420

gift knowing that persons going to name it we already have in mind what theyre going to find

415

00:20:03,420 --> 00:20:08,759

and when they say live unicorn we go well thats interesting right so the point of this game is to

416

00:20:08,759 --> 00:20:13,299

one remind ourselves we have to get out of our own way like but to see this as an opportunity and to

417

00:20:13,299 --> 00:20:18,759

have fun i love watching people play this the number of smiles that i saw amongst you and i

418

00:20:18,759 --> 00:20:22,720

have to admit when i first started some little dour a little doubting okay but in that last game

419

00:20:22,720 --> 00:20:27,119

you were all smiling and look like were having fun so when you reframe the spontaneous speaking

420

00:20:27,119 --> 00:20:29,940

opportunity as as enough as something that you can

421

00:20:30,000 --> 00:20:34,539

co-create and share, all of a sudden you are less nervous, less defensive, and you can accomplish

422

00:20:34,539 --> 00:20:38,740

something pretty darn good. In this case, fun out. This reminds us of perhaps the most famous of all

423

00:20:38,740 --> 00:20:44,640

improvisation saying yes and. A lot of us live our communication lives saying no but. Yes and

424

00:20:44,640 --> 00:20:48,380

opens up a tremendous amount of opportunity. And this doesnt mean you have to say yes and to a

425

00:20:48,380 --> 00:20:51,740

question somebody asks. This just means the approach you take the situation. So youre going

426

00:20:51,740 --> 00:20:56,440

to ask me questions. That's an opportunity. Yes and I will follow through versus no. So we've

427

00:20:56,440 --> 00:20:59,980

accomplished the first two steps of our process. First, we get out of our own way.

428

00:21:00,000 --> 00:21:02,160

Second, we reframe the situations enough.

429

00:21:02,220 --> 00:21:05,160

The next phase is also hard, but very rewarding.

430

00:21:05,240 --> 00:21:06,200

That is slow down.

431

00:21:06,319 --> 00:21:09,759

You need to understand the demands of the requirement you find yourself in,

432

00:21:09,779 --> 00:21:10,940

in order to respond appropriately.

433

00:21:10,960 --> 00:21:12,440

But often, we jump ahead.

434

00:21:12,559 --> 00:21:14,660

We listen just enough to think we got it,

435

00:21:14,700 --> 00:21:17,460

and then we go ahead starting to think about what were going to respond,

436

00:21:17,539 --> 00:21:18,079

and then we respond.

437

00:21:18,160 --> 00:21:19,079

We really need to listen.

438

00:21:19,140 --> 00:21:21,200

Because fundamentally, as a communicator,

439

00:21:21,279 --> 00:21:23,299

your job is to be in service of your audience.

440

00:21:23,400 --> 00:21:25,940

And if you dont understand what your audience is asking or needs,

441

00:21:26,039 --> 00:21:26,779

you cant fill that obligation.

442

00:21:26,819 --> 00:21:29,319

So we need to slow down and have fun gaming.

443

00:21:29,319 --> 00:21:29,940

In this game,

444

00:21:30,000 --> 00:21:38,940

you are going to S-P-L-L-E-V-E-R-Y-T-H-I-N-G-Y-O-U-S-A-Y-T-O-Y-O-U-R-P-A-R-T-N-E-R.

445

00:21:39,000 --> 00:21:39,619

I will translate.

446

00:21:39,759 --> 00:21:41,660

Youre going to get with the same partner you just worked with,

447

00:21:41,700 --> 00:21:45,759

and you are going to have a very brief conversation about something fun that you plan to do today.

448

00:21:45,880 --> 00:21:47,759

I know this is the most fun youre going to have all day,

449

00:21:47,759 --> 00:21:49,099

but the next fun thing youre going to do,

450

00:21:49,099 --> 00:21:51,880

you are going to tell your partner what you are going to do that will be fun today,

451

00:21:51,960 --> 00:21:55,579

but you are going to do so by S-P-E-L-L-I-N-G-I-T.

452

00:21:55,660 --> 00:21:56,740

So youre going to spell it.

453

00:21:56,799 --> 00:21:58,660

Its okay if you are not a good speller, okay?

454

00:21:58,660 --> 00:21:59,940

You will see the benefit.

455

00:22:00,000 --> 00:22:04,059

doing so with the partner you just worked with person a is going to go first this time you are

456

00:22:04,059 --> 00:22:08,339

simply going to tell your part actually youre going to spell to your part what it is of fun

457

00:22:08,339 --> 00:22:12,059

something of fun that youre going to do what you were really going to do for fun and not do things

458

00:22:12,059 --> 00:22:16,680

like f e e d t h e c a right just because you dont want to spell right so you can use big words

459

00:22:16,680 --> 00:22:20,640

all right 30 seconds each spell to your partner something fun that youre going to do today would

460

00:22:20,640 --> 00:22:28,940

you like to play go ahead e x c l l e n t i h o p e t h a t t a t y w i thank you that was very good

461

00:22:28,940 --> 00:22:29,980

thank you if you have not

462

00:22:30,000 --> 00:22:31,500

Not switched, switch.

463

00:22:31,720 --> 00:22:34,099

Take 30 more seconds with the new partner spelling.

464

00:22:34,299 --> 00:22:36,559

G-R-E-A-T exclamation point.

465

00:22:36,680 --> 00:22:44,740

T-H-A-N-K-Y-O-U-P-L-E-A-S-E-T-A-K-E-Y-O-U-R-S-E-A-T.

466

00:22:45,000 --> 00:22:46,180

So what did we learn?

467

00:22:46,279 --> 00:22:47,180

What did we learn?

468

00:22:47,259 --> 00:22:48,960

Besides that were not so good at spelling.

469

00:22:49,059 --> 00:22:50,920

You have to pause between the words.

470

00:22:51,140 --> 00:22:53,519

How did this change your interaction

471

00:22:53,519 --> 00:22:54,400

with the person you were interacting with?

472

00:22:54,440 --> 00:22:55,279

What did you have to do?

473

00:22:55,319 --> 00:22:57,059

Focus and listen.

474

00:22:57,059 --> 00:22:59,119

And you cant be thinking ahead.

475

00:22:59,119 --> 00:23:00,059

You have to be in the moment.

476

00:23:00,000 --> 00:23:04,299

When you listen and truly understand what a person is trying to say,

477

00:23:04,440 --> 00:23:05,980

then you respond better or respond.

478

00:23:06,099 --> 00:23:07,359

We often dont listen.

479

00:23:07,460 --> 00:23:09,740

So we start by getting out of our own way.

480

00:23:09,839 --> 00:23:12,099

We then reframe the situation as an opportunity.

481

00:23:12,160 --> 00:23:13,700

Those are things we do inside our head.

482

00:23:13,759 --> 00:23:16,480

But in the moment of interacting, we have to listen first before we respond.

483

00:23:16,980 --> 00:23:19,500

Perhaps my most favorite maxim comes from this act.

484

00:23:19,559 --> 00:23:21,140

Dont just do something, stand there.

485

00:23:21,240 --> 00:23:22,900

Listen, listen, and then respond.

486

00:23:22,980 --> 00:23:23,880

Now, how do we respond?

487

00:23:23,980 --> 00:23:25,700

That brings us to the fourth part of our process.

488

00:23:25,779 --> 00:23:27,200

And that is, we have to tell a story.

489

00:23:27,200 --> 00:23:30,019

We respond in a way that has struck all stories.

490

00:23:30,000 --> 00:23:34,960

have struck we have to respond to struck the key to successful spontaneous speaking and by the way

491

00:23:34,960 --> 00:23:39,119

planned speak is having a structure i would like to introduce you to two of the most prevalent and

492

00:23:39,119 --> 00:23:42,799

popular and useful structures you can use communicate a message in a sponsor but before

493

00:23:42,799 --> 00:23:46,480

we get there we have to talk about the value of structure it increases what is called processing

494

00:23:46,480 --> 00:23:50,880

fluency the effectiveness of which or through which we process information we actually process

495

00:23:50,880 --> 00:23:55,039

structured information roughly 40 percent more effective than information that's not struck i

496

00:23:55,039 --> 00:23:59,039

love looking out in this audience because you will remember as i remember phone numbers when you had

497

00:23:59,039 --> 00:24:01,920

to remember them

498

00:24:00,000 --> 00:24:00,980

if you want to call somebody.

499

00:24:01,140 --> 00:24:03,440

Young folks today don't need to remember phone numbers.

500

00:24:03,500 --> 00:24:05,079

They just need to look at a picture, push a button,

501

00:24:05,140 --> 00:24:06,900

and then the voice starts talking on the other end.

502

00:24:06,960 --> 00:24:07,839

10-digit phone numbers,

503

00:24:07,920 --> 00:24:09,539

its actually hard to remember 10-digit phone numbers.

504

00:24:09,599 --> 00:24:10,279

How did you do it?

505

00:24:10,299 --> 00:24:11,579

You chunked it into a structure.

506

00:24:11,680 --> 00:24:12,480

Three, three, and four.

507

00:24:12,680 --> 00:24:13,460

Structure helps us.

508

00:24:13,500 --> 00:24:15,599

The same is true when speaking spontaneously

509

00:24:15,599 --> 00:24:16,400

or in a planned situation.

510

00:24:16,460 --> 00:24:17,819

So let me induce you to a useful structure.

511

00:24:17,859 --> 00:24:19,779

The first useful structure you have probably heard

512

00:24:19,779 --> 00:24:21,019

or used in some incarnation,

513

00:24:21,160 --> 00:24:23,279

it is the problem-solution-benefit structure.

514

00:24:23,319 --> 00:24:25,380

You start by talking about what the issue is, the problem.

515

00:24:25,480 --> 00:24:27,099

You then talk about a way of solving it,

516

00:24:27,140 --> 00:24:28,640

and then you talk about benefits of following.

517

00:24:28,640 --> 00:24:30,000

Very persuasive, very effective.

518

00:24:30,000 --> 00:24:33,839

helps you as the speaker remember it helps your audience know where youre going when i was a tour

519

00:24:33,839 --> 00:24:37,779

guide on this campus many many years what do you think the single most important thing they drilled

520

00:24:37,779 --> 00:24:41,839

into our head it took a full quarter by the train to be a tour guide they used to line us up at one

521

00:24:41,839 --> 00:24:45,980

end of the quad and have us walk backwards straight and it failed you had to start over to this day i

522

00:24:45,980 --> 00:24:49,440

can walk backwards in a straight line because as part of that training what do you think the most

523

00:24:49,440 --> 00:24:54,500

important thing they taught us was never lose your tour group im not joking never thats never lose

524

00:24:54,500 --> 00:24:58,039

your tour group the same is true as a presenter never lose your audience the way you keep your

525

00:24:58,039 --> 00:24:59,980

audience on track by fighting struck none of you

526

00:25:00,000 --> 00:25:03,180

would go on a tour with me if I said, hi, my names Matt. Lets go. You want to know where

527

00:25:03,180 --> 00:25:06,559

youre going, why youre going there, how long its taking. You need to set expectations. Problem

528

00:25:06,559 --> 00:25:10,319

solution benefit is a wonderful structure to have in your back pocket. Its something that you can

529

00:25:10,319 --> 00:25:13,579

use quickly when youre in the moment. It can be reframed so its not always a problem youre

530

00:25:13,579 --> 00:25:16,900

talking about. Maybe its an opportunity. Maybe theres a market opportunity. You want to go out

531

00:25:16,900 --> 00:25:20,200

and have. Its not a problem that were not doing it, but maybe wed be better off did. So it becomes

532

00:25:20,200 --> 00:25:24,099

opportunity solution, which are the steps to achieve it. And then another structure, which

533

00:25:24,099 --> 00:25:28,299

works equally, equally well is the what, so what, now what structure. You start by talking about

534

00:25:28,299 --> 00:25:29,960

what it is. Then you talk about.

535

00:25:30,000 --> 00:25:32,140

why its important, and then what the next steps are.

536

00:25:32,180 --> 00:25:34,640

This is a wonderful formula for answering questions,

537

00:25:34,740 --> 00:25:35,599

for introducing people.

538

00:25:35,680 --> 00:25:37,680

So if in the moment somebody asks me to introduce somebody,

539

00:25:37,779 --> 00:25:39,660

I change the what to who, I say who they are,

540

00:25:39,720 --> 00:25:41,019

why theyre important, what were going to do next.

541

00:25:41,099 --> 00:25:42,579

Maybe listen to them, maybe drink our wine, whatever.

542

00:25:42,740 --> 00:25:43,460

What, so what, now.

543

00:25:43,480 --> 00:25:44,359

The reality is this.

544

00:25:44,400 --> 00:25:46,380

When you are in a spontaneous speaking situation,

545

00:25:46,380 --> 00:25:47,900

you have to do two things simultaneously.

546

00:25:48,180 --> 00:25:50,259

You have to figure out what to say and how to say it.

547

00:25:50,279 --> 00:25:52,740

These structures help you by telling you how to say it.

548

00:25:52,759 --> 00:25:54,880

If you can become comfortable with these structures,

549

00:25:54,880 --> 00:25:56,720

you can be in a situation where you respond

550

00:25:56,720 --> 00:25:58,059

very ably, spontaneously.

551

00:25:58,299 --> 00:25:59,099

Were going to practice that.

552

00:25:59,160 --> 00:25:59,400

We do.

553

00:25:59,400 --> 00:26:00,039

Heres the situation.

554

00:26:00,000 --> 00:26:04,259

situation. Is everybody familiar with this childs toy? Its a slinky. You are going to sell this

555

00:26:04,259 --> 00:26:08,720

slinky to your partner using either problem solution benefit or opportunity solution. What

556

00:26:08,720 --> 00:26:12,519

does the slinky provide? Or you could use what, so what, now what? What is it? Why is it important?

557

00:26:12,599 --> 00:26:16,759

And next steps might buy. So by using that structure, see how already it helps you. It

558

00:26:16,759 --> 00:26:20,319

helps you focus. Get with your partner. Were only going to have one partner sell to the other

559

00:26:20,319 --> 00:26:23,920

partner. So get with your partner. One of you will volunteer to sell to the other, okay? Sell a

560

00:26:23,920 --> 00:26:29,500

slinky using problem solution benefit or what, so what, now what? So when I debrief this, you go

561

00:26:29,500 --> 00:26:29,839

past them.

562

00:26:30,000 --> 00:26:37,079

30 more seconds please excellent lets all close the deal seal the deal i have never seen more

563

00:26:37,079 --> 00:26:42,180

people in one place doing this at the same time i love it i teach people to gesture and gesture big

564

00:26:42,180 --> 00:26:47,180

its great i love it so if you were the recipient of the the sales pitch thumbs up did they do a

565

00:26:47,180 --> 00:26:51,180

good job did they use the structure awesome im recruiting you all for my next business is my

566

00:26:51,180 --> 00:26:55,319

sales please try to ignore this but as were speaking the handout i told you about is coming

567

00:26:55,319 --> 00:26:59,980

around on the back of that handout you are going to see a list of structure the two we talked about

568

00:26:59,980 --> 00:27:00,480

you

569

00:27:00,000 --> 00:27:02,880

and several others that can help you in spontaneous speaking situations.

570

00:27:02,980 --> 00:27:07,039

These structures help because they help you understand how youre going to say what you say.

571

00:27:07,500 --> 00:27:08,819

Structure sets you free.

572

00:27:08,900 --> 00:27:10,599

And I know that's kind of ironic, but it's true.

573

00:27:10,680 --> 00:27:13,900

If you have that structure, then you're free to think about what it is you're going to say.

574

00:27:14,000 --> 00:27:17,579

It reduces the cognitive load of figuring out what you're saying and how you're going to say it.

575

00:27:17,619 --> 00:27:18,759

All of this is on that handout.

576

00:27:18,920 --> 00:27:20,059

So what does this all mean?

577

00:27:20,119 --> 00:27:24,019

It means that we have within our ability the tools and the approaches

578

00:27:24,019 --> 00:27:26,319

to help us in spontaneous speaking situations.

579

00:27:26,319 --> 00:27:28,920

The very first thing we have to do is manage our anxiety

580

00:27:28,920 --> 00:27:29,980

because you cant be in effect.

581

00:27:30,000 --> 00:27:34,000

speaker if you dont have your anxiety. And we talked about how you can do that by greeting

582

00:27:34,000 --> 00:27:38,160

your anxiety. Reframing is a conversation being in the present. Once you do that, you need to

583

00:27:38,160 --> 00:27:42,900

practice a series of four steps that will help you speak spontaneously. First, get out of your

584

00:27:42,900 --> 00:27:47,200

own way. I would love it if all of you on your way from here to the football game pointed things and

585

00:27:47,200 --> 00:27:51,039

called them the wrong name. Itll be fun. If most of us do it, then it wont be weird. If only one

586

00:27:51,039 --> 00:27:55,579

or two of us do, itll be weird. Second, give gifts. By that, I mean see your interactions as

587

00:27:55,579 --> 00:27:59,940

ones of opportunity, not challenge. Third, take the time to listen. Listen. And then

588

00:28:00,000 --> 00:28:01,180

Finally, use structure.

589

00:28:01,240 --> 00:28:02,339

You have practiced these structures.

590

00:28:02,380 --> 00:28:03,980

I practice these structures on my kids.

591

00:28:04,059 --> 00:28:04,619

I have two kids.

592

00:28:04,680 --> 00:28:05,539

When they ask me questions,

593

00:28:05,640 --> 00:28:07,559

I usually answer them in what, so what, now what.

594

00:28:07,599 --> 00:28:08,259

They dont know it,

595

00:28:08,299 --> 00:28:09,720

but when they go over to their friends houses

596

00:28:09,720 --> 00:28:11,599

and they see their friends ask their dads questions,

597

00:28:11,700 --> 00:28:13,200

they dont get what, so what, now what.

598

00:28:13,299 --> 00:28:14,380

So, you know, you have practice.

599

00:28:14,500 --> 00:28:15,400

The more you practice humbly,

600

00:28:15,500 --> 00:28:17,380

ultimately, you have the opportunity

601

00:28:17,380 --> 00:28:18,759

before you become more compelling,

602

00:28:18,920 --> 00:28:20,519

more confident, more connected as a skirt

603

00:28:20,519 --> 00:28:21,740

if you leverage these texts.

604

00:28:21,839 --> 00:28:23,200

If you're interested in learning more,

605

00:28:23,279 --> 00:28:23,980

this is where I'd plug.

606

00:28:24,059 --> 00:28:24,819

I've written a book.

607

00:28:24,920 --> 00:28:25,920

Many of the MBA students

608

00:28:25,920 --> 00:28:27,400

who take these communication classes here

609

00:28:27,400 --> 00:28:28,200

that I and others teach,

610

00:28:28,240 --> 00:28:28,539

read it.

611

00:28:28,619 --> 00:28:29,940

Its called Speaking Up Without Freaking Out.

612

00:28:30,000 --> 00:28:33,559

More importantly, theres a website here that I curate called No Freaking Speaking.

613

00:28:33,799 --> 00:28:37,740

And it has lots of information that Ive written and others have written about how to become more effective.

614

00:28:37,859 --> 00:28:38,900

So thats the end of my plug.

615

00:28:38,940 --> 00:28:42,700

What Id really like to do is enter into a spontaneous speaking situation with you.

616

00:28:42,759 --> 00:28:45,140

And I would love to entertain any questions that you have.

617

00:28:45,220 --> 00:28:47,559

There are two people who are running around with microphones.

618

00:28:47,640 --> 00:28:49,420

So some of us remember the Phil Donahue show.

619

00:28:49,480 --> 00:28:50,700

Were going to do a little bit of that.

620

00:28:50,700 --> 00:28:53,279

If you have a question, the microphone will come and Im happy to speak.

621

00:28:53,480 --> 00:28:54,960

We can hear you.

622

00:28:55,119 --> 00:28:56,759

Can you talk about hostile situations?

623

00:28:56,779 --> 00:28:57,619

Hostile situations, yes.

624

00:28:57,619 --> 00:28:59,980

So when you find yourself in a challenging situation.

625

00:29:00,000 --> 00:29:04,700

first it should not become a surprise it should not be a surprise before you ever speak you should

626

00:29:04,700 --> 00:29:09,000

think about what is the environment going to be like so it shouldn't surprise you that there might

627

00:29:09,000 --> 00:29:12,900

be some challenges when there are hostile situations that arise you have to acknowledge

628

00:29:12,900 --> 00:29:17,380

so if somebody says that's a ridiculous idea why did you come up with that to simply say so the

629

00:29:17,380 --> 00:29:21,920

idea I came up with was right acknowledge the emotion I recommend not naming the okay so you

630

00:29:21,920 --> 00:29:25,259

sound really angry person I'm not angry I'm frustrated now we're arguing over their mental

631

00:29:25,259 --> 00:29:29,319

right emotion so so I say something like I hear you have a lot of passion on this issue or I hear

632

00:29:29,319 --> 00:29:30,019

there's great concern

633

00:29:30,000 --> 00:29:34,000

you so you acknowledge the emotions otherwise it sits in the room and then reframe or respond the

634

00:29:34,000 --> 00:29:38,299

way that makes sense so if somebody raises their hand and says your product is ridiculously priced

635

00:29:38,299 --> 00:29:42,200

why do you charge so much i might say i hear great concern what you really ask about is the value of

636

00:29:42,200 --> 00:29:45,579

our product value proposition then i would back say because the value we buy we believe in price

637

00:29:45,579 --> 00:29:49,799

so you answer the question about price but you reframe it in a way that you feel more comfortable

638

00:29:49,799 --> 00:29:54,099

answer so the way to do this is practice all the skills we just taught the only skill that im

639

00:29:54,099 --> 00:29:58,279

adding this is the awareness and advance that might be in that situation first i have to truly

640

00:29:58,279 --> 00:30:00,019

listen what im hearing right its very easy

641

00:30:00,000 --> 00:30:03,680

for me when i hear a challenging question to get all defensive and not hear what the persons asked

642

00:30:03,680 --> 00:30:08,079

i see it as an opportunity to reframe and say so again yeah practice but thats how its other

643

00:30:08,079 --> 00:30:11,119

other questions i see a question back here yes please well thank you very much presentation

644

00:30:11,119 --> 00:30:15,119

for a lot of the the speaking i do i have remote audiences audiences all over

645

00:30:15,119 --> 00:30:20,480

country with any tips for those so when you are speaking in a situation where not everybody is

646

00:30:20,480 --> 00:30:25,279

co-located in fact right at this very moment there are people watching this presentation remote what

647

00:30:25,279 --> 00:30:30,000

you need to do is be mindful of it second try to include engagement techniques

648

00:30:30,000 --> 00:30:31,880

Where the audience actually has to do something.

649

00:30:31,980 --> 00:30:33,920

So physical participation is what we did here.

650

00:30:34,000 --> 00:30:34,319

Games.

651

00:30:34,440 --> 00:30:36,319

You can ask your audience to imagine something.

652

00:30:36,420 --> 00:30:37,819

Imagine what it would be like if.

653

00:30:37,880 --> 00:30:38,940

When we try to achieve a goal.

654

00:30:39,000 --> 00:30:40,640

Rather than saying heres the goal were trying to achieve.

655

00:30:40,720 --> 00:30:42,119

Say imagine what it would be like if.

656

00:30:42,200 --> 00:30:43,019

See what that does to you.

657

00:30:43,059 --> 00:30:43,460

It pulls you in.

658

00:30:43,519 --> 00:30:44,480

I can take polling questions.

659

00:30:44,559 --> 00:30:46,920

Most of the technology that youre referring to has some kind of polling.

660

00:30:46,920 --> 00:30:50,619

You can open up some kind of wiki or google doc or some collaborative tool.

661

00:30:50,740 --> 00:30:54,099

Where people can be doing things and you can be monitoring that while youre presenting.

662

00:30:54,180 --> 00:30:55,480

So I might take some breaks.

663

00:30:55,660 --> 00:30:57,880

I talk 10-15 minutes and say okay lets apply this.

664

00:30:57,940 --> 00:30:59,740

And lets go into this google doc I created.

665

00:30:59,740 --> 00:31:00,000

And I.

666

00:31:00,000 --> 00:31:02,440

I see what, so its about variety and its about gauge.

667

00:31:02,559 --> 00:31:04,339

Those are the ways really connect people who are remote.

668

00:31:04,460 --> 00:31:04,940

Other questions?

669

00:31:05,019 --> 00:31:06,779

Youre pointing, oh, Ive got to look where the mics at.

670

00:31:06,779 --> 00:31:10,319

This might be a similar first question, but Mike, whats your record?

671

00:31:10,519 --> 00:31:12,740

Specifically, I feel like Im being cross-examined.

672

00:31:12,839 --> 00:31:16,480

Right, so in any speaking situation that you go into that has some planned element,

673

00:31:16,559 --> 00:31:19,839

I recommend identifying certain themes that you think are important or believe in.

674

00:31:19,900 --> 00:31:23,680

And then with each one of those themes, have some examples and concrete evidence that you support.

675

00:31:23,759 --> 00:31:26,720

You dont go in with memorized terms or ways of saying it.

676

00:31:26,720 --> 00:31:29,700

You just have ideas and themes, and then you put them together as necessary.

677

00:31:29,700 --> 00:31:30,000

So whats the best way to do that?

678

00:31:30,000 --> 00:31:33,460

When Im in a situation where Im interrogated, I have certain themes that I want to get across.

679

00:31:33,579 --> 00:31:36,339

Make sure that I do that in a way that fits the needs of the moment.

680

00:31:36,400 --> 00:31:43,099

If its hostile, again, the single best tool you have to buy yourself time and to help you answer a question officially is paraphrasing.

681

00:31:43,140 --> 00:31:45,819

The paraphrase is like the Swiss army knife mutation.

682

00:31:46,039 --> 00:31:47,160

You remember the show MacGyver?

683

00:31:47,240 --> 00:31:48,380

Its your MacGyver tool, right?

684

00:31:48,380 --> 00:31:56,819

So when a question comes in, the way you paraphrase it allows you the opportunity to reframe it, to think about your answer, and pause and make sure youve got it right.

685

00:31:56,880 --> 00:31:58,960

So when youre under those situations, you have the opportunity to paraphrase it.

686

00:31:58,960 --> 00:31:59,980

So what youre really asking about.

687

00:32:00,000 --> 00:32:04,000

is x y and z that gives you the opportunity to employ one of these now ive never been an expert

688

00:32:04,000 --> 00:32:07,880

witness because im not an expert on anything but those tools i believe the microphone is back thank

689

00:32:07,880 --> 00:32:12,339

you so much this has been so helpful and enjoyable this morning would you please show the last screen

690

00:32:12,339 --> 00:32:17,160

so we have information absolutely thank you i think they actually theyre you might even have

691

00:32:17,160 --> 00:32:20,220

an opportunity you know its on the sheet too everything i said is on the back of that sheet

692

00:32:20,220 --> 00:32:24,380

but im happy to have this behind me while i while i talk other questions yes please yes i

693

00:32:24,380 --> 00:32:29,960

with that from that represent many different cultural backgrounds so are there any caveats

694

00:32:30,000 --> 00:32:36,359

or is this a universal strategy so in terms of from your perspective as a speaker i believe this

695

00:32:36,359 --> 00:32:40,720

applies but when you whenever you communicate part of the listening aspect is also thinking

696

00:32:40,720 --> 00:32:44,759

about is who is my audience and what are their expectations so what are the cultural expectations

697

00:32:44,759 --> 00:32:48,559

the audience that i present so there might be certain norms and rules that are expected so

698

00:32:48,559 --> 00:32:53,059

when i travel and do talks i have to take into account where im doing the presentation so i i

699

00:32:53,059 --> 00:32:57,859

help present in the ignite probe not heard about that here is fantastic and i just did a presentation

700

00:32:57,859 --> 00:32:59,920

standing in one of these awesome classrooms

701

00:33:00,000 --> 00:33:00,579

that have all these cameras.

702

00:33:00,640 --> 00:33:02,299

And I just taught 35 people Santiago.

703

00:33:02,460 --> 00:33:06,720

And I needed to understand the cultural expectations of that area

704

00:33:06,720 --> 00:33:09,019

and what they expect and what they're willing to do when I ask this.

705

00:33:09,099 --> 00:33:12,279

So it's a part of that listening step where you click on what are the expectations.

706

00:33:12,279 --> 00:33:13,619

I think we have time for two more questions,

707

00:33:13,759 --> 00:33:15,819

and then I'm going to hang around afterwards if anybody has a question.

708

00:33:15,920 --> 00:33:17,819

But some of these folks really want me to keep on schedule.

709

00:33:17,940 --> 00:33:18,220

Yes, please.

710

00:33:18,279 --> 00:33:19,160

I wanted to ask a question.

711

00:33:19,339 --> 00:33:21,160

One of the things that youve done effectively in your talking,

712

00:33:21,220 --> 00:33:24,000

and Ive seen other effective speakers do, is interject humor in their talk.

713

00:33:24,240 --> 00:33:26,279

What are the risks and rewards of trying to do that?

714

00:33:26,319 --> 00:33:27,180

Well, first, thank you.

715

00:33:27,220 --> 00:33:28,420

And I appreciate all of you laughing.

716

00:33:28,420 --> 00:33:30,000

Thats the sum total of all.

717

00:33:30,000 --> 00:33:34,480

my jokes you heard i am not funny honest jokes so humor is wonderfully connected its wonderfully

718

00:33:34,480 --> 00:33:38,980

connected right to a neck it is very very risky cultural reasons get away sometimes what you think

719

00:33:38,980 --> 00:33:44,380

is funny what research tells us is that if youre going to try to be funny self-deprecating humor is

720

00:33:44,380 --> 00:33:49,019

your best bet because it is the least risk there is nothing worse than putting out a joke and having

721

00:33:49,019 --> 00:33:53,079

no response it actually sets you back farther than if you would have got where you would have

722

00:33:53,079 --> 00:33:56,660

gotten joke so basic fundamentals you need to think about with you one is it funny how do i

723

00:33:56,660 --> 00:34:00,000

know i ask other people second what happens if it doesnt work have a

724

00:34:00,000 --> 00:34:03,539

back and then third if youre worried about the answers to those first two dont do it right one

725

00:34:03,539 --> 00:34:07,559

last question please the mic on is right here and then like i said i will hang around yes please i

726

00:34:07,559 --> 00:34:12,340

sort of on the opposite of this since i am a journalist i frequently have to ask spontaneous

727

00:34:12,340 --> 00:34:18,719

questions of people who have been through media training yes so so any tips for chinks in the

728

00:34:18,719 --> 00:34:24,139

armor way to ask ask a question without being antagonistic but get facsimile of a straight

729

00:34:24,139 --> 00:34:28,780

answer well so let me give you two answers one is i i have young boys and the power of the why

730

00:34:28,780 --> 00:34:29,920

is great just ask why

731

00:34:30,000 --> 00:34:33,599

couple times and get through that first two layers of training. Why do you say that? How do you

732

00:34:33,599 --> 00:34:38,460

about that? The second bit is to what I have found successful in getting people to, I do this to get

733

00:34:38,460 --> 00:34:42,219

people answered more often. What Ill do is Ill ask them, give advice. So what advice would you

734

00:34:42,219 --> 00:34:46,000

give somebody whos challenged this? Or what advice would you give somebody in this way? By asking for

735

00:34:46,000 --> 00:34:50,119

the advice, it changes the relationship they have with me as the question asker. And I often get

736

00:34:50,119 --> 00:34:53,800

much more rich. So the power of the why, and then put them in a position writing guide. And that

737

00:34:53,800 --> 00:34:58,179

really, with that, I am going to thank you very much. I welcome you to ask questions later and

738

00:34:58,179 --> 00:35:00,039

enjoy the rest of your reunion weekend. Thank you.

739

00:35:00,000 --> 00:35:00,840

Thank you.